

» AFTER

After Long Tan, the Australian presence increased, peaking at 7,672 soldiers in 1968.

CORAL-BALMORAL

In the wake of the communist offensive known as **Mini Tet** in May 1968, much of the First Australian Task Force was sent to Lai Khe to block enemy movement out of Saigon. Its main fire support bases in the area, Coral and Balmoral, were attacked for 26 days, making **Coral-Balmoral** the Australians' bloodiest battle of the war, with 25 deaths. Australian involvement declined in 1970 as part of **Vietnamization**. The last Australian military personnel left in December 1972.

COMMEMORATION

Australia suffered 521 deaths during the war. It holds Vietnam Veterans' Day on August 18, the day of the Battle of Long Tan.



LONG TAN MEDALLION